

PIG-NOSED TURTLE

The only species in the family Carettochelyidae, this turtle is an omnivore. Its carapace lacks hard scutes, but is still rigid. Its snout is adapted for breathing air while submerged.

PIG-NOSED RIVER TURTLE

Carettochelys insculpta

This nocturnal turtle is found in New Guinea and N. Australia. Like sea turtles, it has forelimbs modified as flippers for aquatic flight.

70 cm
28 in



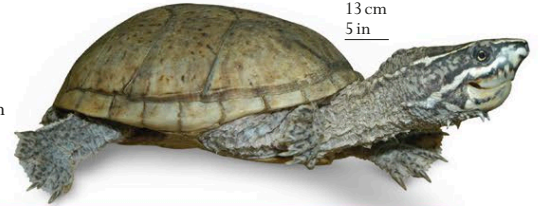
AMERICAN MUD AND MUSK TURTLES

These turtles from the New World emit a strong scent when threatened. The Kinosternidae tend to walk along the bottom of lakes and rivers, rather than swim, and are opportunistic omnivores. They lay elongated, hard-shelled eggs.

COMMON MUSK TURTLE

Sternotherus odoratus

This freshwater turtle from eastern N. America is an omnivore. When threatened, it not only exudes a nauseating musk, but also bites.



13 cm
5 in

EASTERN MUD TURTLE

Kinosternon subrubrum

An omnivore, this freshwater turtle feeds on the bottom of slow, shallow watercourses in the S.E. USA.

13 cm
5 in

LEATHERBACK SEA TURTLE

There is only one species in the Dermochelyidae. This turtle is capable of maintaining an elevated body temperature, which allows it to swim in cold waters. The shell has no scutes; the leathery skin covers a layer of insulating oily tissue.



1.5 m
5 ft

LEATHERBACK SEA TURTLE

Dermochelys coriacea

Feeding mainly on jellyfish, this oceanic sea turtle is the world's largest turtle. It has a worldwide distribution that includes subarctic waters.

clawless flippers

SEA TURTLES

Sea turtles occur throughout the world's oceans, mainly in coastal waters. They are highly adapted to the marine environment, with a streamlined body and broad, paddle-like limbs. The Cheloniidae come to land to nest on beaches. Most species in this family are endangered.

vertebral keel
in younger
turtles

LOGGERHEAD SEA TURTLE

Caretta caretta

This carnivorous species occurs in coastal waters worldwide but undertakes long migrations between feeding and nesting grounds.

pale coloration
on underside

75 cm
30 in

1.2 m
4 ft

large head with
prominent eyes
and beak

GREEN SEA TURTLE

Chelonia mydas

This is the only sea turtle known to bask on land. It is found in temperate and tropical oceans worldwide and is a strict herbivore.

1.3 m
4 1/4 ft

almond-shaped
eyes

flattened carapace
with large scutes

OLIVE RIDLEY SEA TURTLE

Lepidochelys olivacea

A species of mainly tropical, shallow coastal waters, this turtle eats a wide range of invertebrates and algae.

1 m
3 3/4 ft

HAWKSBILL SEA TURTLE

Eretmochelys imbricata

This turtle uses its horny jaws to forage for molluscs and other prey. It is found in tropical oceans throughout the world.

